

Free Scene "First Date?" by Jonathan Dorf

JD/ jonathandorf.com/free-scene/first-date/



From [Me, My Selfie & I](#)

Two teens, Mark and Ashley, at a coffee shop with their laptops and books. *Me, My Selfie and I* is published by YouthPLAYS. [Click here to purchase a copy.](#)

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MARK

And that is how you lower carbon emissions in a Third World city to be named later twenty-five percent by 2040 [or an appropriate year for your production]. Boom.

ASHLEY

Well, if you had money and people who would actually do it.

MARK

Yeah. There's that.

ASHLEY

But boom.

MARK

If we get less than an A...

ASHLEY

We are so getting an A.

MARK

We should definitely be partners again.

ASHLEY

Definitely.

MARK

When?

(Verbalizing his interior monologue to the audience:)

What was that?

ASHLEY

Well, whenever we need partners again, I guess.

(Verbalizing her own:)

“Whenever”? That’s a total blow-off.

MARK

(Verbalizing:)

Talk about the project.

ASHLEY

(Verbalizing:)

Say something nice.

MARK

(Verbalizing:)

You’re good at talking about the project.

(To Ashley:)

The—what do you call the guys who pour the drinks?

ASHLEY

Baristas?

MARK

Yeah, the baristas are good here.

ASHLEY

Yeah.

MARK

(Verbalizing:)

Project! Not baristas. Project!

ASHLEY

(Verbalizing:)

“Yeah”? Seriously? Come on, Ashley!

(Beat. To Mark:)

I love the baristas here.

MARK

I learned a lot about the Third World.

ASHLEY

I love the Third World.

(Verbalizing:)

What?! Are you insane?!

MARK

(Verbalizing:)

Save this save this save this.

(To Ashley:)

Selfie?

ASHLEY

(Verbalizing:)

Oh no—what do I do?!

(To Mark:)

Heck yeah, selfie!

(Until noted, the conversation shifts back to the characters' interior monologues.)

MARK

Why did I say that?

ASHLEY

I can't believe I just said yes.

MARK

She's going to know.

ASHLEY

He's going to know.

MARK

OK. Breathe.

ASHLEY

(Reassuring herself:)

You're good, Ashley. You're good.

MARK

Think of something else.

ASHLEY

What does my mom say? "Redirect your energy."

MARK

Wait—did she just smile at me?

ASHLEY

He does this weird thing when he's thinking.

MARK

Of course she smiled. We just finished the project.

ASHLEY

He puts his lips together and crinkles his nose and looks like a baboon. It's kind of adorable.

MARK

That was so not a "project is finished" smile.

ASHLEY

I think he likes me too.

MARK

I think she likes me too.

MARK & ASHLEY

(Beat.)

This is our first date!

MARK

And I'm wearing my aunt shirt!

ASHLEY

My face looks—

MARK

My great-aunt has no taste in shirts.

ASHLEY

Let's not call it a zit. Let's call it a "temporary imperfection."

MARK

I love her to death, but I've never met anybody with so much tacky stuff.

ASHLEY

A really imperfect imperfection.

MARK

I shouldn't pick out my clothes until I open my eyes all the way.

ASHLEY

If we use my phone, I could Photoshop [edit] that—

MARK

If I take it, I can Photoshop [edit] this shirt out.

ASHLEY & MARK

(To each other:)

I'll take it.

ASHLEY

(To Mark:)

I think my phone has a better camera.

MARK

(To Ashley:)

They're both about the same, and I...

(He waves his phone in the air to indicate that it's already out. Beat. Both are again in their heads until otherwise noted.)

ASHLEY & MARK

I'm blowing it.

MARK

This is so gonna be my Waterford. Wait—that's my mom's china. Napoleon. Waterloo. Crap—I'm pretty sure I wrote Waterford on the test.

ASHLEY

Feasible, narcolepsy, eaglet. Sixth grade spelling bee words, go away. Barramundi.

MARK

At least I'm gonna get an A on this project.

ASHLEY

Crocodiles kill their prey by grabbing it in their jaws and twisting around and around, dragging it under the water and drowning it.

MARK

And an A+ for ruining our first date.

ASHLEY

It's called a death roll.

MARK

Probably our last date.

ASHLEY

It seems slow and painful and horrible beyond all imagining.

MARK

I need to be bold. Mayday. Mayday.

ASHLEY

I am my own crocodile.

MARK

(To Ashley:)

Maybe...

ASHLEY

(To Mark:)

Yes...?

MARK

(To Ashley:)

I know we both want to selfie really bad.

ASHLEY

(Back in her head:)

Where's he going with this...?

MARK

(To Ashley:)

But if we do it before we present, we might jinx it.

ASHLEY

Jinx it?

(In her head:)

That totally works!

MARK

(In his head:)

Please don't hate me.

ASHLEY

(To Mark:)

Yeah. I think that makes sense.

(In her head, simultaneously:)

He's perfect!

MARK

(In his head, simultaneously:)

She's perfect!